



Snapchat Custom Stories

Snapchat now lets you create custom stories limited to specific friends, or only to direct contacts. <http://dgit.in/SnapCustom>



GOT season 7 analysis

HBO just dropped a fresh trailer for Game of Thrones Season 7 – and this is our frame by frame analysis. <http://dgit.in/GOTs7DGT>

02 ENROLLING IN THE ANDROID BETA PROGRAM



Android and provide feedback. Devices that you receive updates for Android O. The updates that you'll receive as part of the beta program may affect normal functioning of your device. Issues, and make the platform even better.

When you receive Android O, you may remain in the beta program for a period of time. If you choose to do so, you will receive updates as they are available. At the end of the program, you will receive the final version of Android O.

The easiest and most hassle-free method out of the two, users of the beta program receive previews through OTA updates. Here, you don't need to worry about unlocking your bootloader and then flashing the factory images. All you need to do is sign up for the Android Beta program portal (<http://dgit.in/AndOBeta>) with the Google ID used in your Pixel or Nexus device. As you scroll down, you will see your device listed

under "Your eligible devices". Next, click on "Enroll device" and go through the steps to eventually receive the beta over an OTA update. After the update finishes downloading, restart your device and you will be running the Android O beta. Since it's an OTA update, you won't lose the existing data on your phone but it's a healthy exercise to backup all your data, especially important stuff, before installing any system update.

03 FLASHING THE FACTORY IMAGE



In order to manually install Android O beta on your Pixel or Nexus device, you need an unlocked bootloader. We've already covered in detail on how to unlock your bootloader in the "Customise your smartphone" article from previous month's (May 2017) cover story. Now would be the time to revisit that particular section for a quick refresher. This method also requires you to install and use the Android SDK (<http://dgit.in/AndStdSDK>). That's why henceforth, we will assume that you have some level of experience with the SDK tools.

Assuming you've already downloaded the factory image from the link mentioned in the first step, let's move on to flashing the image to your

device. Having adb and fastboot setup with Android SDK or just the Platform Tools (<http://dgit.in/AndPTools>) in this case, we recommend you to extract the files from the zipped factory image directly to the Platform Tools folder. Open the folder and while keeping the shift key pressed, right click in the explorer and click on the "Open command prompt here". With USB debugging enabled, reboot your device to the fastboot mode and type adb devices to verify whether your phone is detected by your system. Then enter the flash-all command to flash the required files. After the flashing process completes, you can reboot your device to find your phone running the Android O beta.

04 VIEW NOTIFICATIONS DOTS



If you've been using Nova Launcher Prime for a while then you must be familiar with notification badges. These are tiny dots or numbers that appear on top left of the app icons denoting an unread notification. In Nova Prime, you not only get the dot but also the number of unread notifications. You can further customise to change the colour, size and location of the notification dot. In the Android O beta, you only get a dot on the top right of the app icon. Tapping the icon

will throw the extended menu of the app, as already available in Nougat. But with Android O, the notification also appears in the extended menu in a small window. Although the window is too small to fit the entire notification, you will be able to scroll through if there are more than one notifications in that small window. This feature is quite helpful for IM and messaging apps where you only need to glance at the text. It becomes almost worthless for email though.